Before describing how the search methods work, let’s take a closer look at an example of an R-tree in figures 10.3 and 10.4. We will restrict to the 2-D case because it is easier to visualize but, as always, you have to imagine that real trees can have hold 3-D, 4-D or even 100-D points.

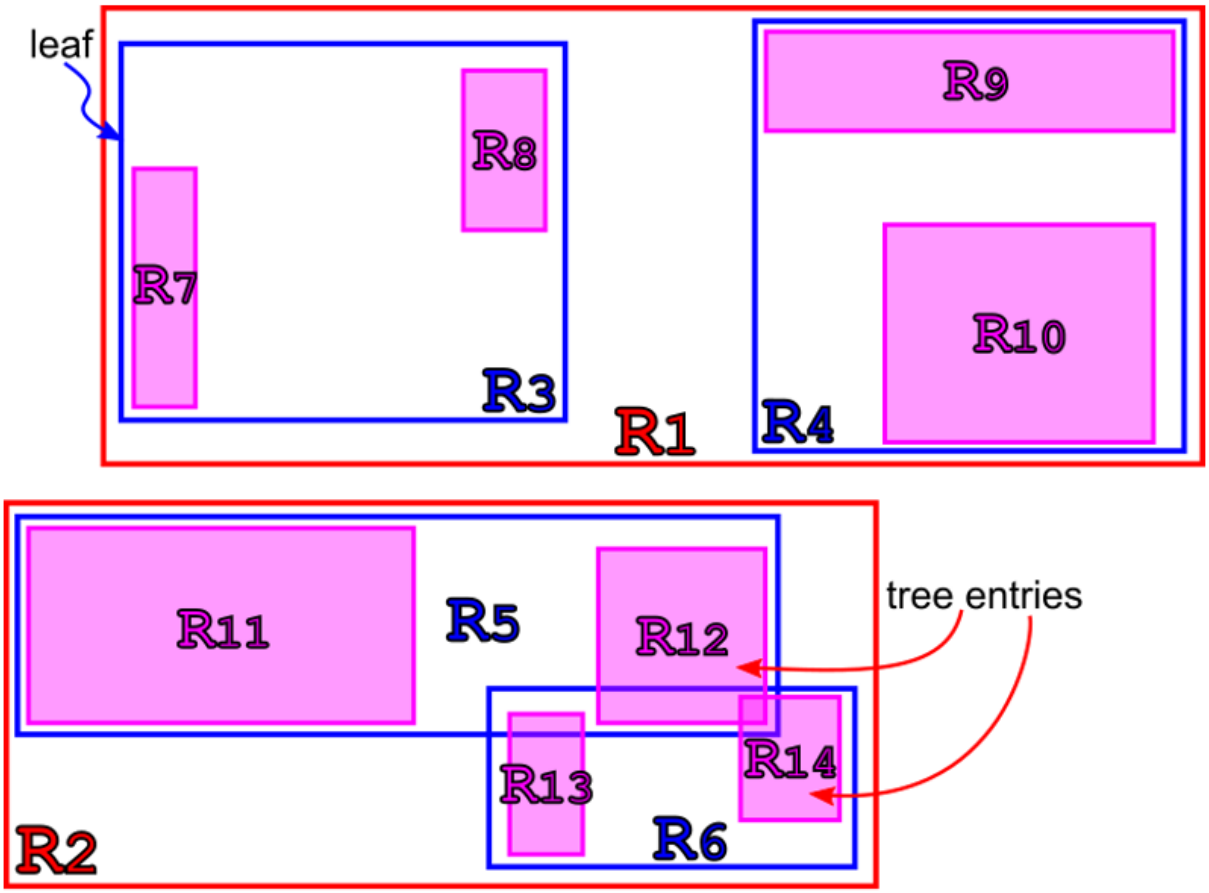


Figure 10.5 R-trees entries, besides points, can also be rectangles, or non-zero-measure entities. In this examples, entities R7 to R14 are the tree’s entries, while R3 to R6 are the tree’s leaves.

If we compare figure 10.3 to figure 9.6, showing how a k-d tree organizes the same dataset, it is immediately apparent how the two partitioning are completely different: